Assignment 7: Phonetics

Ling 201 – Fall 2026

(100 pts total)

Please **do not use external sources such as the internet or AI to find the answers**. If you need an **extension**, please ask before the deadline. **General American pronunciation is assumed here**.

Part 1. English Consonants Identifying

Identify the **first consonants** in the given English words and provide the IPA symbol and the description (voicing, place, and manner) for it. *(3 points/item, 24 points total)*

example *dental* [d] voiced alveolar stop

1.	vote	[v]	voiced	labiodental	fricative
2.	this	[ð]	voiced	dental	fricative
3.	germ	[dʒ]	voiced	post-alveolar	affricate
4.	note	[n]	(voiced)	alveolar	nasal
5.	shock	[ʃ]	voiceless	post-alveolar	fricative
6.	hair	[h]	voiceless	glottal	fricative
7.	gone	[g]	voiced	velar	stop/plosive
8.	yellow	[j]	voiced	palatal	approximant/glide

Part 2. English Vowel Identifying

Identify **the vowels** in the given English words and provide the IPA symbol and the description (height, backness, and roundedness) for it. *(2 points/item, 12 points total)*

example *can* [æ] front low unrounded

1.	sit	[ɪ]	high	front	unrounded	lax	vowel
2.	more	[ɔ]	mid	back	rounded	lax	vowel
3.	booth	[u]	high	back	rounded	tense	vowel
4.	set	[ɛ]	mid	front	unrounded	lax	vowel
5.	book	[ʊ]	high	back	rounded	lax	vowel
6.	say	[ej]	mid	front	unrounded	tense	vowel

Part 3. Phonetic Transcription: IPA to English

Translate the following IPA transcriptions into English spelling. *(1 points/item, 10 points total)*

example [kənfjuʒn̩] confusion

1. [wɛnzdej] → Wednesday
2. [θɑwzn̩d] → thousand
3. [ɹʌtgəɹs] → Rutgers
4. [hɛzətejt] → hesitate
5. [bejðiŋsut] → bathing suit
6. [kjukʌmbɹ̩] → cucumber
7. [pʰɪlgɹɪm] → pilgrim
8. [ælfəbɛrɪk] → alphabetic
9. [bajlɪŋgwəl] → bilingual
10. [kɑnsənənt] → consonant

Part 4. Phonetic Transcription: English to IPA

Provide the phonetic transcription for the given English words. *(2 points/item, 24 points total, question 9 and 10 count as 2 items)*

example *can* [kæn] (Don't forget the brackets!)

1. hit → [hɪt]
2. vet → [vɛt]
3. hood → [hʊd]
4. wedge → [wɛdʒ]
5. think → [θɪŋk]
6. who → [hu]
7. party → [pʰɑɹi] / [pʰɑɪti]
8. wing → [wɪŋ]
9. Facebook → [fejs bʊk]
10. Snow White → [snow wajt]

Part 5. Sound Classes

For each description, mark all of the given IPA symbols that fit the description on the left (the number of correct answers may vary by question). Only consider symbols on the same line as the description. *(15 points total)*

1. voiced velars	[v]	[g]	[r]	[ð]	[ŋ]	[ɣ]	[k]
2. low (open) vowels	[i]	[ə]	[æ]	[o]	[ɑ]	[ɛ]	[y]
3. voiced stops/plosives	[ɢ]	[t]	[b]	[ɱ]	[h]	[ɻ]	[d]
4. alveolars	[n]	[s]	[β]	[θ]	[ɹ]	[ʁ]	[x]
5. rounded vowels	[æ]	[ɛ]	[ʊ]	[ɪ]	[o]	[e]	[u]

Part 6. Reading Sentences in IPA

Write the following broad phonetic transcriptions in regular English spelling. *(5 points/item, 15 points total)*

1. fənɛtɪks ɪz ðə stʌdi əv spitʃ saʊndz

   Phonetics is the study of speech sounds.

2. sʌm pipəl θɪŋk fənɛtɪks ɪz vɛɹi ɪntəɹəstɪŋ

   Some people think Phonetics is very interesting.

3. ɔl spoʊkən læŋgwɪdʒəz juz saʊndz pɹədjust baj ðə ʌpəɹ ɹɛspəɹətɔɹi sɪstəm

   All spoken languages use sounds produced by the upper respiratory system.

Extra Credit

This part is **optional**. If you attempt it, you will receive *at least 1 extra point* on top of your grade. Up to ***5 points*** may be awarded based on the quality of your answer. *(5 points)*

Write a phonetic transcription for each of the ***italicised words*** in the following excerpt of a poem entitled ***Brush Up Your English*** published long ago in a British newspaper.

I take it you already ***know***

Of ***tough*** and ***bough*** and ***cough*** and ***dough***?

Some may stumble, but not you,

On ***hiccough***, ***thorough***, ***slough*** and ***through***?

…

A ***moth*** is not a moth in ***mother***,

Nor ***both*** in ***bother***, ***broth*** in ***brother***.

know	[now]
tough	[tʰʌf]
bough	[baw]
cough	[kʰɔf] / [kʰɑf]
dough	[dow]
hiccough	[hɪkʰʌp]
thorough	[θʌɹə]
slough	[slu] / [slʌf] / [slaw] / [slow] (multiple pronunciations)
through	[θɹu]
moth	[mɔθ]
mother	[mʌðəɹ] / [mʌð̩]
both	[bowθ]
bother	[bɑðəɹ] / [bɑð̩]
broth	[bɹɔθ]
brother	[bɹʌðəɹ] / [bɹʌð̩]